



Review

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holdings. It was home to Abbot Ludegar, a monastic author of the first half of the thirteenth century. In 1540 the abbey was secularized. The library went mostly to the University of Leipzig. All of this we have from the editor in the brief but informative historical introduction.

The present work admirably brings together more than a century and a half of scholarship. Already by 1855 Eduard Beyer had made a register of more than 900 documents related to Altlein. Since that time scholars have culled documents from more than forty archives and libraries in and out of Germany. Graber includes three forgeries (nos. 85, 98, and 108). In this regard, he compares the abbey favorably to the motherhouse, Pforta, where there were seventeen forgeries during the same period of time.

A section of the introduction is devoted to nondiplomatic sources for the history of the abbey's founding. Graber gives twelve transcriptions from chronicles, annals, genealogies, tables, and inscriptions. His editions of these sources are his own, and he has included a detailed apparatus for each. Finally, the rules for the edition of documents are thoroughly presented.

The edition of 153 documents (numbered 1 to 108, 108A, and 109 to 152) fills 235 pages of a book of large proportions. Each document has an apparatus that includes a title, date, description, and footnotes. The title gives briefly the contents of the document. A diplomatic analysis under the heading "original" (save for papal and episcopal register entries) begins each description. Other headings used as needed identify manuscript copies, previous editions, entries in published registers, translations, and formularies (especially those of papal charters). Footnotes for textual and historical comments complete the individual apparatuses. It is hard to imagine fuller diplomatic descriptions. Sigillography is covered as is the basic codicology of the original charters. Paleography is omitted.

There are two bibliographies; the smaller one is dedicated to the history of the abbey and the larger one to general sources and literature. Both bibliographies are flawed by not separating primary and secondary sources. A set of seven appendices and a full index assist the reader in finding and understanding all of the elements of the documents.

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CHARLES HILKEN, F.S.C.

Oltre Cîteaux: Gioacchino da Fiore e l'Ordine fiorense. By Valeria De Fraja. [Centro Internazionale di Studi Gioachimiti S. Giovanni in Fiore: Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore, Testi e strumenti, 19.](Rome: Viella. 2006. Pp. 301, 2 color plates. €30.00 paperback.)

The Transfiguration in Matthew 17:1–13 is a touchstone of Western mysticism and of the churches' approach to mystical experience. The Apostles wit-

ness an event far beyond their comprehension, an irruption of the divine that transforms flesh, time, and space. Their immediate impulse is to build “tabernacles” to commemorate the event, but Jesus warns them, “tell no one about this vision.” Joachim of Fiore’s own attempts to corporealize his deeply mystical understanding resulted in a series of *figurae* that inspired generations of followers after his death and have fascinated and puzzled scholars ever since. Do these *figurae* express the progression of the three great ages, as the consensus holds? Might they, as Caroline Bruzelius and I have suggested, provide literal models for architecture—Sta. Chiara in Naples, for example?

Valeria De Fraja’s groundbreaking work offers another interpretation, one that takes seriously the obligation of the textual scholar to *deconstruct* these verbal and visual *mansiones*—parsing and reassembling their language within their time and place. This detailed, well-annotated, and documented analysis demonstrates the merits of close reading of the texts and *figurae* and of the contexts of their production. It is the outcome of several articles and a dissertation completed under the guidance of Gian Luca Potestà and Roberto Rusconi, reflecting the influence of Herbert Grundmann throughout.

De Fraja’s hypothesis is that beyond being solely the product of a deeply mystical intuition of the turning of the ages—of high theory or mystical intuition—Joachim’s *figurae* (at least tables XII, the *Dispositio novi ordinis* under study here, and XIII, the twin trees) are the result of praxis: of his reflection in the 1180s and 1190s on the task of reforming Cistercian monasticism and building a new order in the Regno of Naples under the late Normans and early Hohenstaufen and in the context of declining Greek monasticism and the reforms of Innocent III. These *figurae* are not—or not only—expositions of universal patterns, of biblical concordances of old and new, but working instructions, visualizations of how an abbot ought to set up a new order that would incorporate harmoniously the three major spiritual communities common to the south at the time (monks, clerics, *and* laity) with a series of houses, outbuildings, and oratories. Joachim’s “mansions” may enshrine deep mystery, but they derive from practical community planning by an engaged and politically astute churchman. This is not to rob Joachim of his spiritual and historical significance: both for Joachim and his followers these schemata embodied mysteries of time and space far beyond the quotidian. De Fraja stresses that they were to incorporate the plan of the heavenly Jerusalem on earth. Nor has De Fraja made Joachim a twelfth-century organizational guru. Instead, she has provided us with a sound philological approach to Joachim’s corpus: taking his words and images as far and as literally as an informed and close reading will allow. Whatever his followers speculated on his works over the next centuries, De Fraja’s Joachim derived his high theory from praxis and on-the-ground experience.

There are caveats for De Fraja’s argument that she acknowledges: the textual evidence from Joachim’s work is fragmentary; the documentation she appends for Joachim’s foundations is sometimes equivocal; the innovations he sets forth

in his schemata were not startlingly new for his time or place, and Joachim's followers failed to incorporate his practical achievements. Nonetheless, De Fraja's thesis, however measured, is compelling. Students of Joachimism and of late medieval spirituality should engage with this book and reflect on the deeply intertwined visibles and invisibles that she perceives here.

Italica Press, New York

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Mary of Oignies: Mother of Salvation. Edited by Anneke B. Mulder-Bakker; translated by Margot H. King and Hugh Feiss, and with additional contributions by Brenda Bolton and Suzan Folkerts. [Medieval Women: Texts and Context, 7.] (Turnhout: Brepols Publishers. 2006. Pp. xii, 260, €60,00; \$89.00.)

This is the first sustained study in English of the holy woman from the diocese of Liège, Mary of Oignies (d. 1213). Her name is normally linked and discussed in association with the preacher Jacques de Vitry. However, in this study Mary is center stage, not as a footnote to the life of the great preacher, but as the most important icon of the early beguine movement.

The book is a group effort that brings together a number of primary sources and short articles that illuminate the riveting contours of Mary's life and contribution to the early beguine movement. Mulder-Bakker provides a helpful introduction outlining the life and times of Mary of Oignies. The introduction is fleshed out by the inclusion of various translations of key primary sources. Some of these sources were originally published in the unfortunately defunct series Peregrina Publications, but now they are conveniently brought together in this one volume. These sources are *The Life of Mary of Oignies* by James of Vitry (translated by Margot H. King), *The Supplement to James of Vitry's Life of Mary Oignies*, *History of the Foundation of the Venerable Church of Blessed Nicholas of Oignies and the Handmaid of Christ Mary of Oignies*, and *The Liturgical Office of Mary of Oignies* by Goswin of Bossut (translated by Hugh Feiss). The liturgical office of Mary of Oignies contains a special Mass and eight offices of the liturgy of the hours. It was produced at the Cistercian monastery of Villers in the early thirteenth century and indicates the intensity of the local devotion to Mary.

The Liturgical Office of Mary of Oignies is followed by two articles that delve into the cult of Mary of Oignies and its dissemination. Brenda Bolton's essay "Mary of Oignies: A Friend to the Saints" assesses the attempts to establish Mary's cult in the years shortly after her death. Bolton argues that the efforts of her ardent supporters, such as Jacques de Vitry, to establish a collection of impressive relics and religious literature failed to ignite an official cult because of the growing papal bureaucracy related to canonization. While the official canonization failed, Suzan Folkerts in her essay "The